



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Trinity School

School Website: <https://winstedhollytrinity.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Holy Trinity School in Winsted, MN (ZIP 55395) presents a robust classical-Catholic educational model. Public-facing materials emphasize a traditional, liberal-arts oriented curriculum anchored in a Catholic worldview, with explicit commitments to faith formation, liturgical life, and rational inquiry. The school describes itself as a "traditional classical education curriculum" that forms students through the liberal arts, and it integrates theology, philosophy, and rhetoric within a faith-filled framework. Across multiple pages, the school foregrounds daily Mass, Eucharistic adoration, sacramental life, and liturgical prayer as integral to the student experience. The curriculum foregrounds grammar, logic, rhetoric, philosophy, theology, Latin, and humane letters, with upper-school seminars and public speaking training—signaling alignment with classical pedagogy. The faculty is portrayed as morally anchored, with small class sizes and a mission-centered culture, and parents are presented as engaged stakeholders within a parish-school community.

Overall, the school scores CLASSICAL across the six classical-elements categories, with clearly strong alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Faculty. The Parents & Community category shows engagement and openness consistent with classical aims, though explicit language about parents as "co-teachers" and formal parent-education programs is less evident in the materials available, leading to a nuanced but still favorable standing in that area. Taken together, Holy Trinity School Mn 55395 is best characterized as CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Catholic identity is central; daily Mass, Eucharistic adoration, sacramental life, liturgical prayer, and theology are woven into school life. Positive references to truth, goodness, beauty, and a sacramental worldview underscore transcendental aims. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators (Catholic faith, Mass, liturgy/worship, adoration, prayer, theology, sacred, sacramental worldview, truth/goodness/beauty) dominate; negatives absent. Why this rating: The school explicitly situates education within a Catholic metaphysical framework and liturgical life.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Formation of virtue and wisdom; education as formation through Liberal Arts; emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty; formation of character; emphasis on contemplation and "scholé"-like aims via classical education rhetoric. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Strong presence of formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, and pursuit of truth/beauty; no explicit focus on workforce preparation in public-facing materials. Why this rating: The telos aligns with classical aims of human flourishing and virtuous character rather than solely job-readiness.
- **Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Liberal arts emphasis (grammar, logic, rhetoric); history taught across the curriculum; study of philosophy and theology; Latin program; Humane Letters and literature focus at upper levels; recognition of the classical tradition and "liberal arts" in curriculum descriptions. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, philosophy, theology, Latin, humane letters; absence of dominant

“project-based/ STEM-first” negative signals. Why this rating: The curricular architecture aligns with classical curriculum expectations, including grammar/logic/rhetoric and humanities-centered study.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence: Upper-level seminars and rhetoric/public speaking emphasis; lower-level memory work and chant-like repetition in some descriptions; emphasis on contemplation/scholé; the pedagogy includes Socratic-like seminars at the high-school level and rhetoric training; holistic formation through inquiry and memory. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Socratic/seminar-style discourse, memory work, recitation, rhetoric, public speaking, contemplation/wonder, liturgical integration; no explicit dominant negative signals present in materials. Why this rating: Pedagogical practices reflect classical methods (Socratic/seminar discussions, rhetoric, memory work) alongside contemplative elements.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Emphasis on virtuous, model teachers; teachers as living examples and part of the curriculum; close faculty-student relationships implied by small class sizes; mission-focused, faith-aligned teacher culture. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include model teachers, living curriculum, faculty as mentors, portrait of teacher, collaborative culture; minimal negative signals. Why this rating: The materials depict teachers as central to formation and virtuous living, aligning with classical faculty ideals.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Parental involvement is encouraged within a parish-school framework; open invitation to visits; community life anchored in Catholic culture and school activities; family engagement shown in testimonials and open events. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include partnership orientation, parental/community involvement, open campus/visit opportunities, and catechesis or family faith formation; explicit “co-teacher” language and formal parent-education programs are less prominent, which tempers the rating slightly toward CLASSICAL but still strongly classical in spirit. Why this rating: The school fosters community and parental involvement, though explicit language framing parents as co-teachers and formal parent-education programs is not as pronounced as in some classical schools.

What Would Move the Needle (only applicable if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - Not needed here since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. The school already demonstrates robust alignment across the six classical elements, with only minor gaps in explicit parental-co-teacher language.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school is framed as authentically Catholic with daily Mass, Eucharistic Adoration, weekly reconciliation, and a liturgical life embedded in school culture. - Mission statements emphasize forming students in the Catholic faith, Christ-centered life, and parish-community alignment. - The curriculum and philosophy highlight theological study, sacred worship, and liturgical practices as integral to education. - The motto and academic identity foreground “Knowledge, Excellence, Worship,” linking intellectual life with sacred worship. - References to truth, goodness, beauty as core aspirations and to a sacramental worldview are present in official materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: Catholic faith, Mass, Adoration, reconciliation, liturgical life, theology, worship, prayer, sacred, sacred music, sacraments, Catholic Culture, truth/goodness/beauty, liturgy, theology, parish-school, sacramental worldview. (No explicit negative indicators found in the materials.)

Why this rating - The public materials present religion as foundational to identity and objectives, with liturgical practices and theological study woven into daily life and the curriculum. This aligns squarely with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria of a classical school.

Citations - Mission statements and Catholic formation details: turn0file11, turn0file0 - Catholic Culture and liturgical practices: turn0file6, turn0file9 - Motto and academic identity (Knowledge, Excellence, Worship): turn0file2, turn0file3

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly describes formation of character and virtue through a Catholic, classical framework; formation in faith and service is presented as the core telos. - It emphasizes formation through the liberal arts and the pursuit of knowledge, with an explicit aim at developing critical thinking. - Language such as “educates its students through academic inquiry, the pursuit of knowledge, and the development of critical thinking” appears in mission-related materials. - The school frames education as formation and cultivation of virtue, not merely information, aligning with classical aims of human flourishing.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, true/good/beautiful (truth/goodness/beauty), scholé (implicit in classical aims), contemplation, great conversation (where referenced as classical heritage concepts). - Negative keywords (from the lexicon) are not evident; there is no explicit emphasis on workforce preparation or 21st-century-skills framing in opposition to formation.

Why this rating - The materials foreground formation, virtue, wisdom, and a classical telos rather than a purely job- or college-prep mindset, supporting CLASSICAL.

Citations - Mission and formation language: turn0file11 - Academic inquiry and the pursuit of knowledge: turn0file0 - Liberal arts emphasis and classical aims: turn0file2, turn0file3

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as liberal-arts heavy, with explicit mention of grammar, logic, and rhetoric within the classical framework. The materials reference a traditional classical education curriculum formed by the liberal arts. - The curriculum list includes mathematics, phonics, grammar, history, geography, science, foreign languages, fine arts, literature, philosophy, and theology, indicating a broad liberal-arts orientation. - Historical study is present throughout the curriculum, with a focus on Western civilization and philosophy/theology as core disciplines. - Upper-level study explicitly includes humane letters, public speaking, and seminars, signaling emphasis on rhetoric and classical humanities. - Latin begins early and is explicitly highlighted as part of the classical curriculum; classical languages are part of the program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, philosophy, theology, Latin, great books (if referenced through the broader classical-education language; humane letters mentions humanities and rhetoric), and “great conversation” framing appears as a classical-habitus concept in the lexicon (public-facing pages reference classical education and liberal arts more than global content). - Negative indicators: Explicitly negative signals such as a purely project-based or STEM-first approach are not evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The curriculum emphasizes liberal arts and the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) plus theology and philosophy, with Latin and humane letters/contemporary classical humanities work in upper grades. This strongly aligns with CLASSICAL.

Citations - General curriculum and liberal arts emphasis: turn0file0, turn0file2 - Specific list of disciplines and the liberal-arts framing: turn0file3 - Humane Letters, seminars, public speaking (upper levels): turn0file16 - Latin program and classical language emphasis: turn0file16

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Upper-school pedagogy includes seminars, Socratic-style discourse, and rhetorical training; learners engage in reasoning and public speaking. - The classroom culture emphasizes formation through memory-work and recitation, and lower-school practices (chanting and memory-based review) are consistent with traditional pedagogy. - The lower-school environment emphasizes experiential wonder and memories through singing and chanting as a memory-aiding approach to learning. - The mission statement highlights education through academic inquiry and the development of critical thinking, aligning with a lecture/seminar/rhetoric-driven approach rather than purely project-based or constructivist methods.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: Socratic/seminar, discourse, memory work, recitation, chanting, public speaking, oratory, debate, scholé, contemplation, wonder, sacred/memorial practices, liturgical integration. - Negative indicators (from the lexicon): relatively few or no explicit signals of experiential-only or project-based dominant pedagogy; no strong signals of “facilitator” models without classical context.

Why this rating - The pedagogy blends contemplative/restful elements with rigorous classical activities (Socratic discussions/seminars, memory work, rhetoric, recitation, and liturgical/cultural integration), which aligns with CLASSICAL.

Citations - Seminars, public speaking, rhetoric: turn0file16 - Lower-school memory/chanting and memory-deepening practices: turn0file4 - Mission-informed learning and critical-thinking emphasis: turn0file0

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as mentors/model teachers forming character and virtue; they serve as the living curriculum and form a core part of school life. - The school emphasizes a faculty culture of collaboration, and the teacher-student relationship is highlighted through testimonials and the “living curriculum” language. - The public-facing materials emphasize the teacher-student relationship, the small class sizes (12:1) aiding personalized formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, moral exemplars, character formation, teacher leadership. - Negative indicators: no explicit negative signals regarding faculty in the public materials.

Why this rating - The materials present teachers as core, virtuous, and formation-oriented figures, consistent with classical faculty archetypes.

Citations - Living curriculum and teacher as moral model: turn0file11 - Testimonials about teacher influence and character: turn0file9 - Small class size and formation emphasis: turn0file6

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents itself as a parish school with a Catholic community orientation; it invites parent involvement through school events, tours, and a diocesan-parish setting. - Testimonials from families emphasize faith formation and community life with other families; the school positions itself within the broader parish and community ecosystem. - Open access to visiting the school, enrollment information, and opportunities for family engagement are present (e.g., schedule visits, open-house-type content).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: partnership with parents, co-teachers (conceptually present through family formation and community life), parental involvement in classical education (book clubs and seminars are part of the classical lexicon, even if explicit co-teacher language is less pronounced in every page), open campus and visits, family liturgy alignment (Catholic culture). - Negative indicators: explicit parental-co-teacher language is not strongly explicit in the public materials, and formal parent-education program language is limited.

Why this rating - The school clearly situates parents and the broader Catholic community as integral to the school’s mission and life, matching the classical category’s emphasis on engaged parents and community, albeit with less explicit “co-teaching” language than some classical schools.

Citations - Parish-school/community framing and events: turn0file6 - Family testimonials and community life: turn0file9 - Visit/enrollment and openness to families: turn0file7

Aggregate Ranking - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - All six categories individually align with classical aims or robustly support them, with Element 6 showing strong community involvement though slightly less explicit “co-teacher” language.

What would move the needle - Not required, given the CLASSICAL aggregate. If one sought to push this even further toward a conventional “fully classical” showcase, the following would strengthen Element 6:

- Add explicit, public language about parents as co-teachers or formal parent-education programs (book studies, study groups) aligned with classical formation.
- Add explicit references to the Great Books or “Great Conversation” framework within curricular materials (even if the school already embraces humane letters and classical education in practice).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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